THE SECOND CHANCE: MY UNEXPECTED JOURNEY

There are moments in life when everything you thought you knew suddenly changes. I never imagined that I would become pregnant during my second year at university.

I was pursuing a Bachelor of Arts, a course I had chosen with high hopes of fulfilling my dreams and those of my family. I had dreams, plans and expectations for my life. Suddenly, I found myself facing a reality I had never prepared for.

My first reaction was fear. My friends and the people I spoke to told me that abortion was the only way I could continue with my education and protect my future. I was confused and overwhelmed, wondering what would happen to my studies, my dreams and my future.

The father of my baby was also a university student. At the time, he was in his third year, and although he tried to support me, he could not fully carry the responsibility because he was still struggling with his own education.

Then there was my family. As the eldest child, I had always enjoyed my father's trust. When he learned that I was pregnant, he was deeply disappointed. His disappointment was painful because I knew how much he believed in me. For a time, he stopped paying my tuition, and I felt that I had lost the person whose support I had always counted on. My mother tried to help me, but my father's disappointment did not completely close his heart to me.

When I spoke to him, he listened. He gave me an opportunity to explain myself. Eventually, he forgave me and brought me back to school. That forgiveness became one of the greatest second chances of my life.

I eventually gave birth, but returning to university did not mean that life suddenly became easy. I now had a baby to care for while trying to continue my education. I had to learn how to be a mother and a student at the same time.

There were moments when I wondered whether I would actually make it to graduation. At times when I desperately needed encouragement, I found a family in an unexpected place.

The president of the Prolife Movement, who was my coursemate, contacted me and introduced me to this family. What began as a simple conversation became a source of support, encouragement and hope. The Prolife Movement became more than an organisation to me. It became a family.

They reminded me that making a mistake or facing an unexpected situation does not mean that a person's life and dreams have come to an end. Their support helped me believe again that I could continue my education and build a future for myself and my child.

Today, I am in my third year and am a finalist. I am also a mother, and I currently live with my baby as I continue my studies.

At every stage, I have faced fear, disappointment and moments when giving up seemed easier than continuing. But I have also experienced forgiveness, kindness, support and love from people who did not have to help me but chose to stand with me.

My story has taught me that sometimes the family that carries you through your darkest moments may come from places you never expected. It has also taught me that one difficult chapter does not have to determine the ending of your story.

My dream is simple but meaningful. I want to study hard, graduate, find a job and give my child a good start in life. I want my baby to grow up knowing that difficult circumstances do not have to destroy a person's dreams.

I am still writing my story. And this time, I am writing it with hope.

With love and gratitude,

A mother. A student. A woman still pursuing her dreams.